



LEANDER MENA | F&B OPERATIONS CONSULTING

Pre-Opening Consulting

From construction walkthrough to opening night

A structured, fixed-scope opening for new restaurant and hotel F&B concepts. One accountable operator coordinates construction, hiring, vendors, training, and launch so you open on time and on budget.

THE PROBLEM

Most openings slip in the same places

Openings rarely fail because of the food. They slip because nobody owns the critical path: equipment lands late, the team is hired but not trained, vendors are chosen in a hurry, and opening week becomes the first real rehearsal.

I have opened a 140-seat Michelin-chef restaurant in Midtown Miami, its fast-casual sister from the same kitchen, and the banquet department of a 124-room luxury hotel with 58,000 square feet of event space. The pattern that works is always the same: a real timeline, written standards, and a team that has rehearsed before the doors open.

The goal is simple: by opening night, your team has already done the job a dozen times.

THE METHOD

How the work runs

Every opening moves through three phases, sized to your timeline and concept.

PHASE 01

Plan

Walk the build, set the 120-day critical path, lock budget, staffing model, and vendor shortlist.

PHASE 02

Build

Hire and train the team, write SOPs and service standards, set purchasing, pars, and the opening menu costing.

PHASE 03

Launch

Run friends-and-family and soft opening, execute the grand opening, then stay 30 days to stabilize.

20 YEARS ON THE FLOOR

20

years in hospitality

1,800

guest hotel grand opening

5,000+

hotel rooms served in-room
dining

\$180K+

saved per year in purchasing

SERVICES

What is included

01 120-Day Opening Roadmap

Week-by-week critical path covering construction handoff, licensing, hiring, training, purchasing, and marketing milestones.

02 Team Recruitment and Training

Staffing model, hiring support, and a training calendar that ends with full rehearsals before opening.

03 SOPs and Service Standards

Front- and back-of-house procedures, steps of service, opening and closing checklists, and food safety systems.

04 Vendors and Purchasing

Vendor selection, contract and price negotiation, order guides, and inventory pars.

05 Menu Costing

Costed recipes and pricing support with your chef so margins are built in from day one.

06 Opening Execution

Soft opening plan, opening-night run of show, and 30 days of post-opening support.

WHAT I LOOK FOR

Five readiness checks before we lock the timeline

Construction and equipment timeline

Is the build date real? I check equipment lead times, inspections, and handoff dates before anything else is scheduled.

Leadership in place

Who will run the restaurant after I leave? The GM and chef should be hired early enough to own the systems.

Budget and staffing model

Does the labor model match the concept, seat count, and projected covers?

Concept clarity

Are menu, service style, and price point settled, or still moving?

Systems and vendors

POS, purchasing, and key vendors need to be chosen early so training happens on the real tools.

None of these is pass or fail. They decide the order of the work, and sometimes the honest answer is that the date needs to move.

WORKING TOGETHER

Engagement options

ENGAGEMENT	SCOPE	TIMELINE
Opening Readiness Review	Timeline audit, gap list, and a written plan your team executes.	1 to 2 weeks
Full Pre-Opening Engagement	Plan, Build, and Launch phases, on-site for key milestones.	3 to 4 months
Post-Opening Stabilization	On-site support after launch to tighten service and costs.	30 days, add-on

THE GROUNDWORK BINDER

What you keep

Everything is handed over so your team can run without me:

- Complete operations manual and SOPs
- Trained opening team and training records
- Vendor contracts and price sheets
- Costed menu and order guides
- Opening-night run of show

Investment

From \$35,000

Fixed-scope project, typically 3 to 4 months.
Complex hotel F&B up to \$75,000.

IDEAL FOR

Who this fits

- First-time restaurant owners
- Hotel developments adding F&B concepts
- Multi-unit expansions
- Concept relaunches and rebrands

Next step

Book a discovery call to walk through your timeline. I will tell you honestly where the risk is.

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NOT READY FOR AN ENGAGEMENT?

The same documents I hand clients are available as self-serve playbooks at menaconsulting.gumroad.com: the 120-Day Pre-Opening Playbook (\$197), the SOP Core Collection (\$97), and focused toolkits for labor, kitchen cost, food safety, FOH and bar, and banquets.